

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 7 4 2
 ♥ J 10 9 6 3
 ♦ 8 6 4
 ♣ J 6

♠ A K Q 5

♥ 7 5

♦ 10 7 2

♣ A 10 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ A 8 4 2

♦ 5

♣ K 9 4 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K Q

♦ A K Q J 9 3

♣ Q 8 3

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	4NT
Pass	5 ♥	Pass	6NT
All Pass			
6NT by South			
Lead: ♥ J			

Then start running the ♦ suit.

This is the situation after you have unblocked dummy's ♣A and then played 5 ♦ winners.

So far neither defender is hurting, but that is about to change.

You play your ♦3 and discard dummy's ♣10.

East is squeezed. He can't throw his ♣K without letting your ♣Q become a winner. But if he discards a ♠ dummy's ♠5 will win the last trick. This is soooo much fun.

South is to play 6NT. West leads the ♥J. East wins the ♥A and returns the ♥2.

With only 11 winners you need to find one more and your prospects are quite slim.

No matter how the ♠s split only one defender will hold the Guard because only one defender can have as many as 4. IF (it's a big IF) that same defender holds the ♣K then you can squeeze him.

Can you see how the squeeze is going to work?

If you try to run your ♦s right away you will have a problem with your ♣Q later on. It will be no good as a Threat card because you will have no entry back to your hand.

The solution is the Vienna Coup. Play a ♣ to the ♣A at trick 3.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 6 4

♥ 10

♦ 10 9 7 4 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 9 3

♥ K 9 8 6 3

♦ A 6

♣ A K Q 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K Q 8 3

♣ J 10 9 3

♠ K 7

♥ A Q J 7 5 2

♦ J 5

♣ 7 6 4

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
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Pass

3♣

Pass

1♥

Pass

6♥

3♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

Lead: ♠Q

Play 5 ♥ winners and the ♠K.

Drum roll please.

Play your ♥2 and dump dummy's ♦6.

East has no answer.

South is to play 6♥. West leads the ♠Q. East wins the ♠A and plays the ♦K.

Of course you have noticed that in most of these hands you are exactly one trick short. No coincidence - it's when you are one trick short and can't find another likely plan that you start to look for a squeeze.

In this hand dummy's fourth ♣ is an obvious Threat, so you should ask yourself if you can find another Threat for when ♣s don't split 3-3. Another thing you have probably noticed is that although 3-3 splits happen about 40% of the time in real life, they **NEVER** happen in these pages!

East's ♦K play helps you find the other Threat. It appears that he must hold the ♦Q also, so your ♦J is now a Threat against East. If he holds 4 ♣s you can squeeze him.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ K Q 10 7 5
 ♦ 10 8 4
 ♣ J 9 5 2

♠ A 5 2

♥ J 6

♦ A K J 7 5 3

♣ K 7

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 10 9 6 4

♥ 9 8 3 2

♦ —

♣ Q 10 6 3

♠ K Q 7 3

♥ A 4

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 8 4

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♦	Pass	4♦
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by South			
Lead: ♥K			

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♥K.

With 12 obvious tricks your first thought should be that perhaps the ♠s will split 3-3.

Then, your second thought should be that dummy's ♥J is a Threat against West's ♥Q, so if it is West who holds 4 ♠s you will be able to squeeze him.

Since the contract is 7NT you take the first trick with the ♥A.

With one trick in the bag you should test ♦s next. When you play the ♦A East discards a ♠.

You continue with the ♦Q and ♦K, East discarding a ♥ and a ♣.

Since East has shown up with a ♦ void he has become the odds-on favorite to hold the ♠ Guard. His ♠ discard makes it very likely that he started with 5 ♠s.

To find out for sure you play ♠A, then ♠Q. Sure enough West discards a ♥ on the second round.

You can't squeeze West in ♥s and ♠s because he doesn't hold the ♠ Guard, East does.

But now a completely new possibility shows up. Say to yourself, over and over, "West must guard ♥s, and East must guard ♠s. Nobody can guard ♣s."

You start playing dummy's ♦ winners.

With one more ♦ in dummy, things look like this.

When you play the ♦5 East must keep both ♠s to guard against your ♠7. So he discards the ♣6, hoping partner can stop that suit.

Your ♠7 is now worthless so you throw it.

West has no problem, (yet), he discards the ♥10.

It is now time to pressure West.

Play dummy's ♠5 to your ♠K.

West MUST keep his ♥Q so he releases his ♣5.

And you win the last three tricks with ♣K, ♣A, ♣8.

This is called a Double Squeeze.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 3

♥ J 10 7 2

♦ 6 3

♣ 10 6

♠ 9 5 2

♥ 6

♦ A J 9 7 4

♣ Q 8 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 6

♥ Q 9 8 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ J 9 7 5

♠ A K 7 4

♥ A K 5

♦ K Q 10

♣ A K 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♦

Pass

7NT

All Pass

7NT by South

Lead: ♠ Q

South is to play 7NT. West leads the ♠ Q.

One more winner is needed. Dummy's fourth ♣ is a possibility.

So take the ♠ K and play ♣ A K Q.

West discards a ♠ on the third ♣.

Now you know East guards the ♣ s.

Before tackling ♦ s, see what you can discover about ♠ s.

Play the ♠ A. East discards a ♥ .

East guards the ♣ s. West guards the ♠ s. Nobody can guard the ♥ s.

Play 4 rounds of ♦ s.

On the fourth ♦ East had to discard a ♥ . You discarded a small ♠ . West discarded a ♠ on the third ♦ and a ♥ on the fourth.

Play dummy's ♦ 4. East cannot throw the ♣ J or he will set up dummy's ♣ 8, so he discards a ♥ .

You discard the ♠ 7.

Now West is squeezed. He cannot discard the ♠ J or he will set up dummy's ♠ 9, so he discards a ♥ .

You win the last three ♥ tricks with another Double Squeeze.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K J 9 4

♥ 6 4

♦ 10 7 2

♣ Q 10 2

♠ 10 8 7 3

♥ Q 10

♦ K Q 6

♣ A 9 7 5



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 7 5 2

♦ J 9 8 4 3

♣ J 4

♠ 5

♥ A K J 9 8 3

♦ A 5

♣ K 8 6 3

West	North	East	South
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1 ♠

2 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

5 ♦

Pass

4NT

All Pass

6 ♥

6 ♥ by South

Lead: ♠ A

from your hand.

Then lead dummy's ♣ 7 to your ♣ K.

Here you are in your hand.

Only West can guard dummy's ♠ 10, and only West can guard dummy's ♣ 9.

So you play your ♥ A and West must give up one of his guards. If he holds on to the ♠ J then you toss dummy's useless ♠ 10. If he throws the ♠ J then you toss dummy's ♣ 9.

South is to play 6 ♥. West leads the ♠ A, then ♠ K.

When you looked at just your and dummy's cards on the previous page it may have looked impossible to find a twelfth winner.

Even looking at all four hands here it is still very difficult to come up with a plan.

Here's a hint: If West holds 3 ♣s, (and you see that he does), can you squeeze him in ♣s and ♠s?

Of course you ruffed the ♠ K.

The big problem with trying to squeeze West in the black suits right now is that East actually holds a ♠ guard. But you can fix that.

Play dummy's ♥ Q and ♥ 10, then ruff a ♠, then pull the last trump.

Now play the ♦ A, ♦ K, and ♦ Q, discarding the ♣ 3